

Fix Your Social Preview

Why this matters

When someone shares a link to your site on LinkedIn, X, or Facebook, a preview card shows up in their feed. That card is built from a handful of meta tags in your page's head tag. If those tags are not there, the platform guesses what to show, and it rarely gets it right.

Since your site is custom built, you have full control over this. It is just a matter of dropping the right tags in the right place.

What you will need

Access to your codebase, a social preview image hosted at a public URL, and about ten minutes.

The tags you need

These are the exact tags that control your social preview. Copy them, fill in your own values, and paste them into your page's head tag. That is all there is to it.

```
<!-- Open Graph (Facebook, LinkedIn) -->

<meta property="og:title" content="Your page title" />

<meta property="og:description" content="Your description here" />

<meta property="og:image" content="https://yoursite.com/og-image.jpg" />

<meta property="og:url" content="https://yoursite.com/page" />

<meta property="og:type" content="website" />

<!-- Twitter Card -->

<meta name="twitter:card" content="summary_large_image" />
```

```
<meta name="twitter:title" content="Your page title" />

<meta name="twitter:description" content="Your description here" />

<meta name="twitter:image" content="https://yoursite.com/og-image.jpg" />
```

What each tag does

You do not need to memorise all of these, but it helps to know what each one controls so you can fill them in with confidence.

Tag	What it controls
<code>og:title</code>	The bold headline on the preview card. Keep it under 60 characters.
<code>og:description</code>	The smaller text below the title. Keep it under 160 characters.
<code>og:image</code>	The preview image. Must be a full public URL, at least 1200 x 630px.
<code>og:url</code>	The canonical URL of the page being shared.
<code>twitter:card</code>	Set this to <code>summary_large_image</code> to get the big image format on X.

Where to paste them

These tags go inside your page's head tag, alongside any other meta tags you already have. If your site has a shared layout file that wraps every page, that is the best place to put your default tags. Then override them per page where needed.

- 1 Find your layout or root file, the one that wraps every page on your site
- 2 Locate the head tag inside it
- 3 Paste the og: and twitter: tags in, filling in your own values
- 4 For pages that need their own preview, override the tags in that page's head
- 5 Deploy your changes

One thing to watch

Your og:image must be a fully qualified public URL, not a relative path. So <https://yoursite.com/og-image.jpg> works, but `/og-image.jpg` will not. Platforms fetch the image directly and need the full address to find it.

Get your image size right

One size covers every platform. Design to 1200 x 630px and you will not have to think about this again.

Platform	Recommended size
X (Twitter)	1200 x 630px
LinkedIn	1200 x 627px
Facebook	1200 x 630px
Safe zone	Keep text and logos within the centre 1000 x 530px

Canva has a pre-sized template called Facebook link image that works perfectly. Just export at 1200 x 630px and host it somewhere publicly accessible.

Check how it actually looks

Once you have deployed your changes, head over to eloho.dev/freebies/social-preview and paste your URL in. You will see exactly what your link looks like across X, LinkedIn, and Facebook, and get a clear breakdown of anything still missing.

Platforms cache previews so changes might not show up straight away. You can force each one to refresh:

- Facebook: Sharing Debugger at developers.facebook.com/tools/debug, click Scrape Again
- LinkedIn: Post Inspector at linkedin.com/post-inspector, click Inspect
- X (Twitter): Card Validator at cards-dev.twitter.com/validator

Before you call it done

- og:title, og:description, og:image, og:url added to your head tag
- twitter:card set to `summary_large_image`
- og:image is a full public URL, not a relative path
- Image is at least 1200 x 630px
- Tags are in the layout file so every page inherits them
- Key pages have their own specific og: tags overriding the defaults
- Checked with eloho.dev/freebies/social-preview

Done? Run your other pages through too.

It is easy to fix the homepage and forget the rest. Paste any URL into eloho.dev/freebies/social-preview and you will see exactly what shows up when that page gets shared.
